

STRUTTING IT

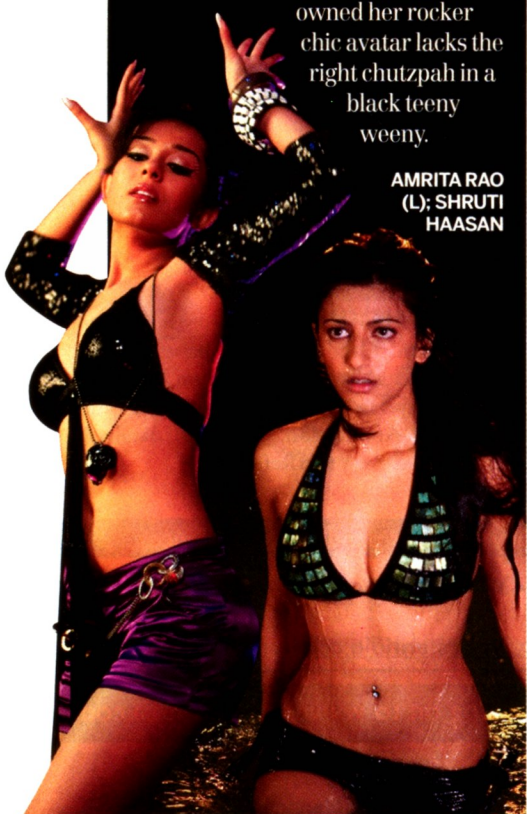
You have to give it to **Amrita Rao**. She has been trying hard to get rid of the ghost of *Vivah*. Exit salwar-kameez, enter hot pants. Rao is seen in bikini tops, leather bustiers and just enough bronzer in *Short Kut-The Con Is On*. She looks good all right, but now she's trying too hard.

VS

Shruti Haasan is in great shape, running down sand dunes and shaking her booty in *Luck*. She's also slunk into the now-necessary bikini.

But the star who owned her rocker chic avatar lacks the right chutzpah in a black teeny weeny.

AMRITA RAO
(L); SHRUTI
HAASAN



EPIC ROLES

Actors from the south are becoming popular in Bollywood. The latest is the Tamil actor Priyamani who plays Surpanakha in Mani Ratnam's *Raavana*. Her casting in the film is just one of the unusual role calls.

Abhishek Bachchan gets under *Raavana*'s skin for the lead. Cropped hair, moustache and weight loss have followed.

Aishwarya Rai Bachchan's middle parting and austere sari in the film only add to her role as Sita. She's in goddess mode.

Govinda plays the modern day Hanuman.

Tamil star **Vikram** steps into Ram's holy shoes as Bachchan junior's bête noire.

Global Tapping

She was the girl who debuted in *Tere Liye* and then vanished. But not many know that **Bhavana Pani**, who's waiting for *Fast Forward* to release, has been playing the lead in an international stage musical, *Bharati*, all over Europe. The actor is seen performing the Lavani, Bhangra and Kathak. "The producers auditioned thousands of Indian girls and I was chosen," says Pani, who plays a dancer in her film too.



ALL IN A TEAM



YOGEN SHAH

The Deshmukh family seems to have suddenly discovered a love for cricket. Daddy Vilasrao Deshmukh will in all probability get the vice presidency of the Mumbai Cricket Association after his opponent dropped out. Almost simultaneously, actor-beta **Riteish** has been chosen brand ambassador of T-10 Gully Cricket's second season. This talent hunt and tournament is played in 16 cities to choose aspiring cricketers. Makes us wonder who's influencing who?

72 ■ Compiled by **Jhilmil Motihar**

Volume XXXIV Number 29; For the week July 14-20, 2009, released on July 13

Light Khao,
Light Raho.



Enriched with natural wheat fibre.

Crisp and Light, perfect with your cup of tea.

0% Transfat 0% Cholesterol

with extra Fibre